

AI Agents at Work

Homework: What Makes an Agent Tick

Name:

Date:

No computer needed! Show what you remember about how agents work. Finish with a quick creative challenge.

Part 1 — Matching

Write the letter of the correct definition in the box next to each term.

- A. An LLM running in a loop, using tools to get a job done.
- B. A plug-in tool pack that gives an agent brand-new abilities.
- C. Saved instructions you write so the agent does a task your way.
- D. How an agent remembers things so it can pick up where it left off.
- E. Tools that come built into the agent, like read, write, and run.
- F. The four-beat cycle: Think, Act, See, Repeat.

Agent

MCP server

Skill

Memory

Built-in tools

The loop

Part 2 — True or False

Write T (true) or F (false) in each box.

An MCP server gives an agent new tools without rebuilding it.

A skill teaches the agent HOW you want a job done, using tools it already has.

Without memory, a model forgets everything between conversations.

Claude Code and Codex are both coding agents you run in a terminal.

You should always share your API key so friends can use it too.

Part 3 — Short Answer

1. Name the four beats of the agent loop, in order.

2. In your own words, what is the difference between an MCP server and a skill?

3. Why does giving an agent a clear, specific mission work better than a vague one?

Part 4 — Creative Challenge

Invent your own agent! Plan it out below.

My agent's name:

What job does it help with?

Write a SKILL for it: a name, when to use it, and 3 steps it should follow.